



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Market Planning

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
2. Explain the concept of marketing strategies.
3. Explain the nature of marketing plans.
4. Describe the nature of target marketing in marketing communications.
5. Identify ways that technology impacts business.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the marketing manager for STYLE CORNER, a regional boutique chain that specializes in women's apparel, accessories, and home décor. STYLE CORNER has built a strong reputation for offering unique and curated items that appeal to fashion-forward women who enjoy a boutique shopping experience.

However, the boutique chain has struggled to stay competitive in an increasingly crowded retail market. Online retailers and fast-fashion giants are taking market share, and the store's current customer base—primarily women aged 35-55—has become more selective with their purchases.

The owner of STYLE CORNER (judge) wants to expand the company's market to attract younger shoppers, particularly those in their 20s and early 30s, while still maintaining the boutique's unique image. The owner (judge) has asked you to develop a market plan that will:

- Attract a younger demographic.
- Maintain loyalty with the existing customer base.
- Differentiate STYLE CORNER from fast-fashion competitors.

The owner (judge) asks that your plan includes: Target market, Marketing strategies, Digital presence, and In-store experience.

You will present your marketing plan to the owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your plan and answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do you plan to differentiate STYLE CORNER from fast-fashion competitors?
2. Can you provide examples of how you envision enhancing the in-store experience to appeal to both younger shoppers and our existing customer base?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of market and market identification?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the concept of marketing strategies?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of marketing plans?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Describe the nature of target marketing in marketing communications?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify ways that technology impacts business?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						